

SMALL RODENTS

These newborn, rubbery, wriggling mice can only squeak, sleep, and suckle.



A rodent is an animal that gnaws with sharp, chisel-shaped teeth. Most are mouselike and vegetarian: they nibble plant stems, seeds, and roots. Forty percent of all mammals are rodents. They live all over the world, from African jungles where crested rats clamber up trees, to scorching deserts where jerboas hop across the sand. House mice have even hitched rides on ships to reach huts in Antarctica.

Moving house

Every three or four years, thousands of lemmings run from their overcrowded homes. Many die in the frantic search for new places to live and feed.



Dormouse

A plague of rats

Every year, millions of nibbling rats wreck one fifth of the world's crops!



Many brown rats live in sewers. They use their feet as paddles when they swim and can tread water for three days!

The greasy fur leaves dirty marks on things it touches.

Flat teeth in the back of a rat's mouth grind up grass and grains.

After walking through dirt, rats may walk over food and spread diseases.

Scaly tail

